

Supplementary information:
Hidden dynamics set the limit—and become the signal—in ghost
imaging

[author block — USER DECISION (mirrors main text, gap G7)]

This supplement carries the proof archive, preregistration archive, operating maps, complete negative campaigns, MOLT, interval construction, and reproducibility ledger (R35 s2.1). Section, equation, table, and figure numbers carry an “S” prefix; “main-text Sec. X” refers to the primary manuscript. Internal method acronyms and audit labels appear only in Notes S6 and S8 (R35 s2.1, s4.3).

- S1 Unified notation and hidden-state experiment**
- S2 Detector hidden-state specialization**
- S3 Ridge asymptotics and verification**
- S4 M1 protocol and provenance**
- S5 Complete M1 results and operating maps**
- S6 Count-only closure campaigns**
- S7 Canonical-confusion reciprocity and DLGI estimator**
- S8 Interval construction and the confirmatory campaign**
- S9 Detector-side escape beyond the count-only model: a real operator with insufficient matched-resource image strength**
- S10 Reproducibility**